TBM COUNCIL

TBM Taxonomy

Version 5.0.1 | July 17, 2025

This paper provides a detailed description of the Technology Business Management (TBM) taxonomy. Developed by the TBM Council Standards Committee, it is published by the Council and is available to read and use at www.tbmcouncil.org/taxonomy, where additional information about the taxonomy, updates in this version, and downloadable data tables can also be found.

Revision History

Date	Reason for Changes	Version
10/31/2016	Final revision with Committee approval and Board of Directors endorsement	V2.0
03/18/2018	Final revision with Committee approval and Board of Directors endorsement	V2.1
11/02/2018	Final revision with Committee approval and Board of Directors endorsement	V3.0
04/19/2019	Added missing High-Performance Computing	V3.0.1
07/18/2019	Added missing “Foundation Platform,” “Order Management” and “Facility & Equipment Maintenance & Repair” definitions	V3.0.2
12/16/2020	Final revision with Committee approval and Board of Directors endorsement	V4.0
11/04/2023	Revision for support of NIST alignment and other technology updates	V4.1
06/06/2025	Final revision with Committee approval and Board of Directors endorsement	V5.0
7/17/2025	Added missing Sustainability & ESG solutions; updated Data, Security, and Risk & Compliance technology resource towers; corrected spelling; and refreshed several graphics	V5.0.1

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Introduction to the TBM Taxonomy

Technology Business Management (TBM) is a value-management framework that enables organizations to optimize their technology value management through greater transparency, alignment, and accountability. At the heart of TBM is the principle of using **structured data and a common language** to align Technology, Finance, and Business stakeholders around the cost, consumption, and value of technology.

The **TBM Taxonomy** provides this common language. Developed and governed by the **TBM Council**, the taxonomy is an open, standard classification system for categorizing technology costs, resources, services, and consumption. It defines the terms and categories that allow organizations to structure their financial and operational data in a consistent, comparable, and repeatable way.

The TBM Taxonomy is developed and governed by the TBM Council, a global community of senior technology, finance, and business leaders who define and evolve the standards for Technology Business Management. The Council ensures that TBM reflects the needs of modern enterprises and remains aligned with best practices across industries.

For an overview of the taxonomy structure and its evolution, visit the TBM Council's taxonomy page. The standard taxonomy structure is shown in **Figure 1**, which outlines the four taxonomy layers, and the categories used within each.

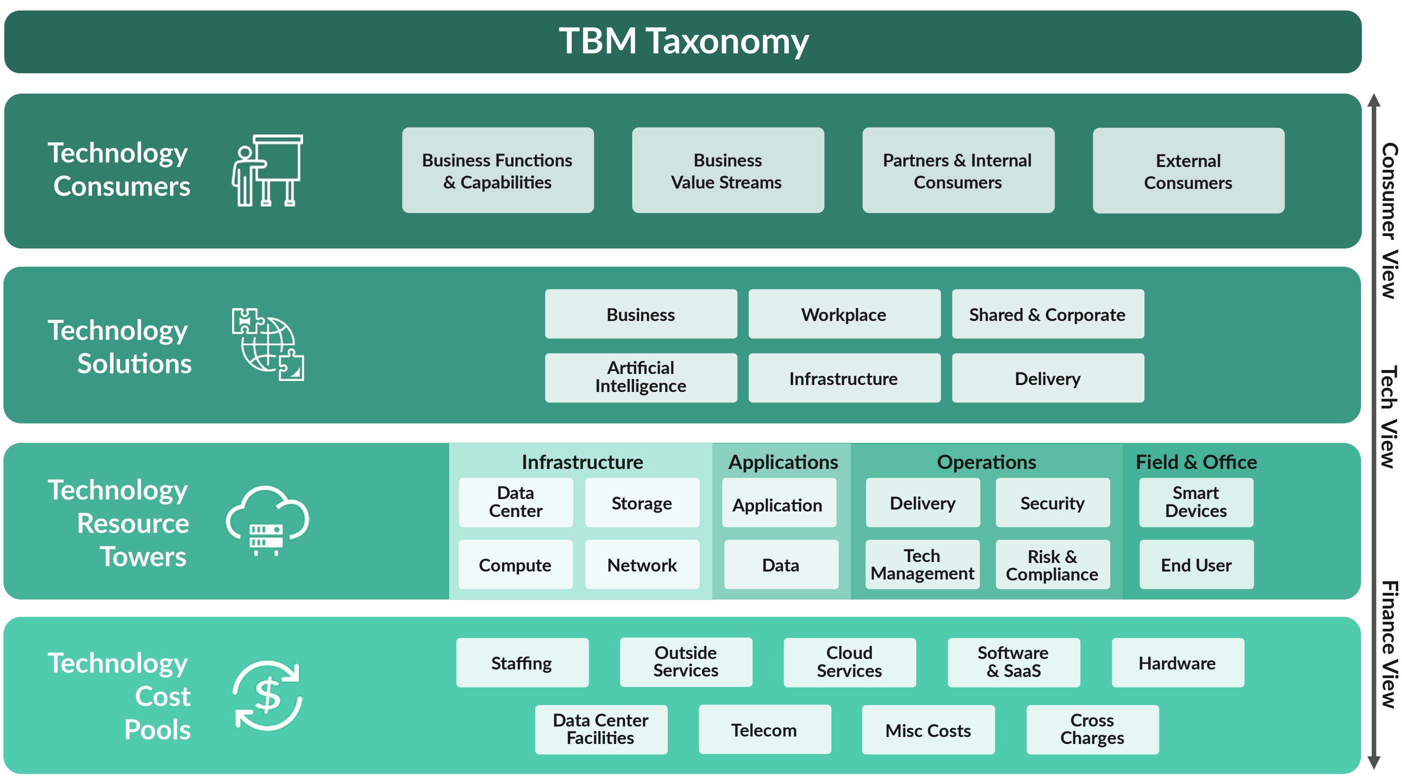


Figure 1: TBM Taxonomy 5.0 Summary View

Similar to how generally accepted accounting principles (GAAP) or international financial reporting standards (IFRS) govern corporate financial reporting, the TBM Taxonomy establishes the standard for reporting, analyzing , and benchmarking technology financials. It ensures that terms like **"compute," "storage,"** or **"solution"** have consistent meanings internally across departments and externally across industries and peers.

The taxonomy is applied through a **TBM model** - a structured representation of how a technology organization's financial, operational, and consumption data interrelate. The model uses taxonomy-based classifications along with allocation rules, consumption metrics, and configuration inputs to create a multi-layered view of how technology resources are funded, deployed, and consumed. This conceptual flow is illustrated in **Figure 2**, which shows how costs move from source to consumer through the layers of the taxonomy.

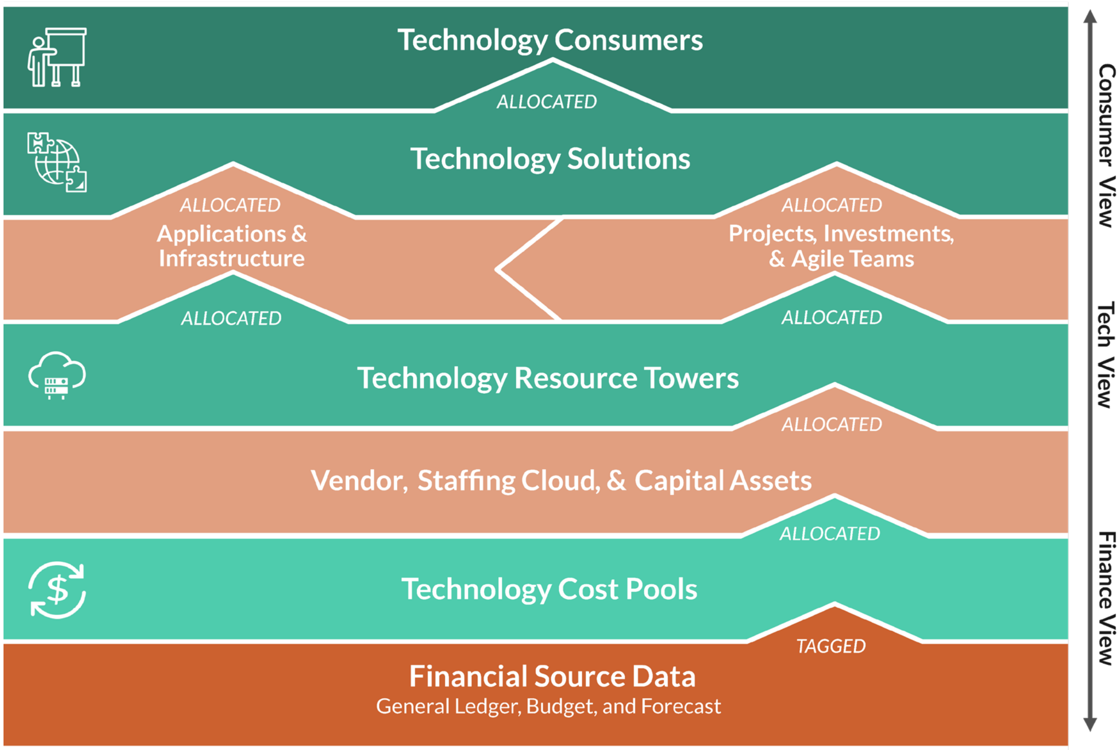


Figure 2: Conceptual TBM Model

By applying the taxonomy within a TBM model, organizations can:

- Improve traceability of spend from source to consumer with auditability
- Compare performance and costs using benchmarks and peer norms
- Create fact-based insights for financial and strategic decisions

This version of the TBM Taxonomy is a foundational component of the broader **TBM Framework**. For an overview of the full framework, visit the TBM Council's framework page.

The taxonomy is structured into four layers: **Technology Cost Pools, Technology Resource Towers**, **Technology Solutions**, and **Technology Consumers**. These layers are introduced in the next section, along with the **Views** they enable—reporting outputs designed to meet the needs of Finance, Technology, Solution, and Business stakeholders.

TBM Taxonomy Structure Explained: Layers and Views

The TBM Taxonomy consists of four interconnected layers: Cost Pools, Technology Resource Towers, Solutions, and Business & Consumers. These layers serve as the organizing framework for structuring technology financials, enabling transparency from the origin of costs to the stakeholders who benefit from technology investments.

Each layer builds upon the one before it, forming the structural backbone of a TBM model. When these layers are employed in a developed model, they enable the generation of Views—reporting outputs that deliver role-specific insights to key organizational stakeholders.

The layers contribute to the model in the following ways:

- **Technology Cost Pools** are standardized financial categories used to organize expenses based on their nature or origin—such as hardware, software, staffing, and outside services. They enable traceability from general ledger systems and other financial sources into the TBM model, supporting accurate allocation of costs across technology functions. Cost Pools distinguish between operating expenses (OpEx) and capital expenses (CapEx), and serve as the foundation for modeling financial performance, unit costs, and value delivery across the taxonomy.
- **Technology Resource Towers** (often referred to simply as "Towers") categorize a Technology organization's resources—such as infrastructure, applications, operational support, and leadership—into standardized functional groupings. Towers organize spend, labor, assets, and other drivers to provide consistent visibility into how technology is structured, delivered, and consumed. They are a critical layer for linking financial data to technical capabilities, and for analyzing cost, performance, and consumption patterns across services and products.
- **Technology Solutions** define what the Technology organization delivers to its stakeholders—such as digital products, business capabilities, or internal services. Each Solution represents a packaged outcome or offering that enables the business to operate, grow, or transform. Solutions are the focal point for planning, managing, and measuring technology value, as they connect the costs and performance of underlying resources to business outcomes. They may be classified as Services (stable, repeatable offerings) or Products (software-enabled capabilities governed through agile or product-based models), and are typically aligned to consumer needs, funding models, and strategic priorities.
- **Technology Consumers** are the recipients of a Technology organization's Solution offerings. They may include business units, shared service groups, external clients, partner organizations, other Technology teams, or the Technology provider itself. Consumers represent the demand side of the TBM model and are essential for tracking usage, allocating costs, and measuring the value delivered. They provide the organizational and financial context necessary to align technology spending with business goals and accountability.

Together, these layers enable the following stakeholder-specific views.

Stakeholders Served by Views

Each View supports the distinct needs of roles across the enterprise:

- **Finance Stakeholders** – CFO, Controllers, Technology Finance, Departmental Budget Owners
- **Technology Stakeholders** – CIO, CTO, Infrastructure and Application Owners, Delivery Leads
- **Solution Stakeholders** – CPO, Product Owners, Service Owners

View Definitions and Model Layer Dependencies

Each View is enabled by incorporating specific taxonomy layers into the TBM model:

- **Finance View**
  Requires the Cost Pool layer. Supports transparency into labor, vendor, capital, and cloud spend—foundational for financial reporting and analysis.
- **Technology View**
  Requires both the Cost Pool and Technology Resource Tower layers. Enables visibility into how costs align to infrastructure, applications, and operational functions.
- **Consumer View**
  Requires all four layers: Cost Pools, Technology Resource Towers, Solutions, and Consumers. Delivers insight into how technology investments support products and services, and which stakeholders consume them.

The Views described above are not separate structures, but rather perspectives enabled by applying the TBM Taxonomy through a developed model. As organizations mature their TBM practices, more layers may be implemented, and additional Views become available. The remainder of this document defines each of the four taxonomy layers in turn, beginning with Cost Pools, the foundation for financial classification and transparency.

Technology Cost Pool Layer

The **Cost Pool layer** is the foundation of the **TBM Taxonomy**. It categorizes the sources of technology spend—such as labor, software, hardware, and cloud services—into standardized groupings known as **cost pools**. Each **cost pool** represents a broad category of cost (e.g.**, Software & SaaS, Labor Resources**, or **Telecom**) and is further broken down into sub-pools that provide greater specificity. For example, the **Labor Resources** cost pool includes **sub-pools** that distinguish between internal personnel and external staff augmentation. This layered structure supports traceability and cost clarity. The complete structure of **cost pools** and **sub-pools** is illustrated in **Figure 3**.

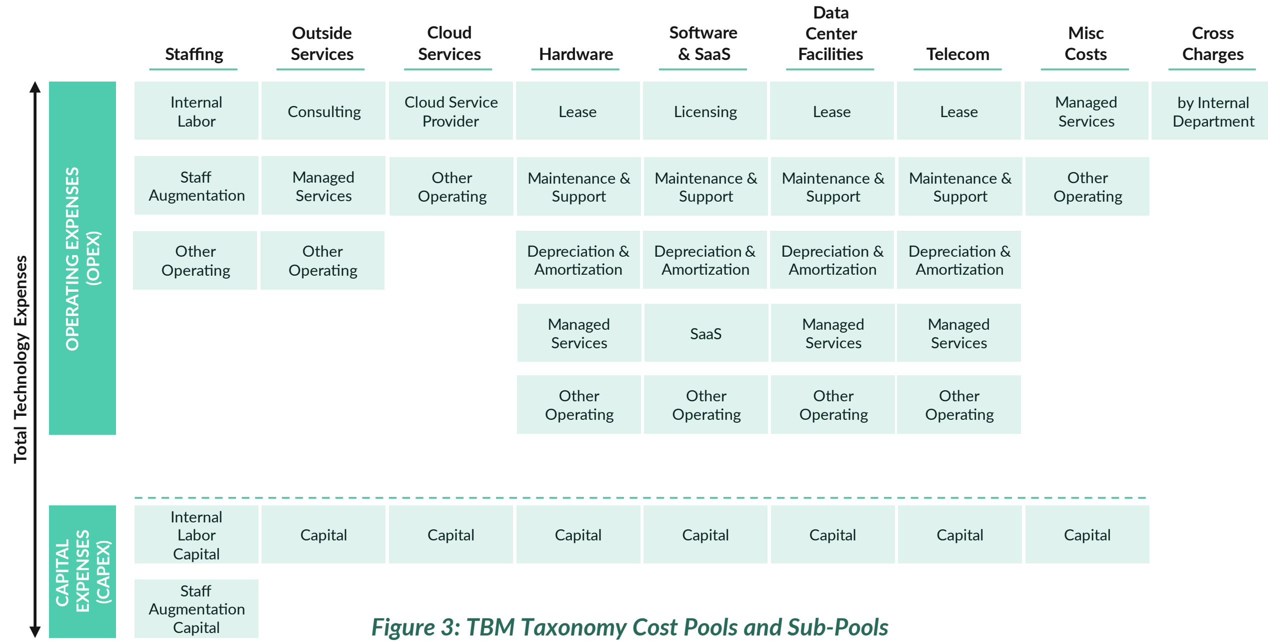


Figure 3: TBM Taxonomy Cost Pools and Sub-Pools

Cost sub-pools are the most granular level of classification in the **TBM Taxonomy** and are typically the point at which technology costs are aligned to **general ledger (GL)** accounts. This enables organizations to connect financial data from accounting systems to the structured cost model used within TBM. The result is improved traceability of spend from its source to its consumption by **Technology Resource Towers, Solutions, or Consumers**. While cost pools provide the foundational classification of spend, some organizations choose to extend the finance layer to reflect vendor relationships, labor sourcing models, and cloud service usage to gain deeper insight into cost drivers.

This structure also supports decomposition of total cost into its constituent elements. For example, the **total cost of ownership (TCO)** of a **Solution** can be analyzed across cost pools such as **hardware**, **software**, **cloud services, staffing, outside services, data center facilities, telecom**, and **cross charges**.

Cost pools distinguish between **OpEx** and **CapEx**, both of which are modeled separately in the TBM framework.

Operating Expenditure

Refers to recurring costs incurred to operate and maintain day-to-day technology services. Examples include salaries for technology staff, monthly vendor payments, utility costs, lease obligations, and short-term software licenses. Within TBM, OpEx typically reflects:

- Costs recognized in the same period they are incurred
- Depreciation and amortization of prior capitalized assets

It excludes capitalized costs, such as software development labor for capital projects or facility buildouts. OpEx appears on the enterprise income statement and reduces reported net income for the current period.

Capital Expenditure

Refers to investments made to acquire, develop, or significantly enhance technology assets with value extending across multiple reporting periods. This includes purchases of infrastructure, capitalizable software development, and long-lived applications such as analytics platforms or ERP systems. In TBM, CapEx is expensed gradually through:

- **Depreciation** (for physical assets such as servers)
- **Amortization** (for intangible assets such as licensed software)

Note: Some organizations depreciate intangible application development. Your Finance team can provide guidance for your organization's specific accounting treatment.

This treatment aligns financial recognition with the asset's useful life, ensuring that costs reflect their long-term benefit to the organization.

The table that follows defines the standard **cost pools** and **sub-pools** used in the **TBM Taxonomy**.

Cost Pool	Cost Sub-Pool	Description
	Operating Expenses (OpEx)	
Staffing	**Includes salaries, benefits, and other costs associated with internal personnel (e.g. employee, temporary employee, intern), Time & Material contractor, and staff augmentation resources delivering or supporting technology services. Excludes consultant and managed service resources.**	
	Internal Labor	Costs for internal labor (e.g. employees, temporary employees, interns). Includes salaries, benefits, occupancy, travel, training, new hire investigation, office furniture, supplies, janitorial services, and any other internal labor related expenses.
	Staff Augmentation	Costs for staff augmentation and Time & Material contractor resources. Includes fees, travel, training, and any other staff augmentation related expenses. Excludes occupancy, office furniture, supplies, and janitorial services.
	Other Operating	Other labor headcount expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Outside Services	**Expenses for external personnel providing technology services that do not contribute to organizational headcount. Includes consulting and managed services engaged for specific projects, operations, or support functions, excluding staff augmentation and Time & Material contractors.**	

Cost Pool	Cost Sub-Pool	Description
Outside Services (continued)	Consulting	Costs for external consulting services, including project-based engagements and advisory support.
	Managed Services	Managed service provider costs for specific operations or project-related activities.
	Other Operating	Other labor expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Cloud Services	**A category for all public, private, and hybrid cloud services, including IaaS and PaaS, supporting enterprise technology infrastructure and applications. Excludes SaaS, which is categorized in the "Software & SaaS" Cost Pool.**	
	Cloud Service Provider	External public cloud expenses, including IaaS and PaaS. Excludes SaaS, which is categorized under the "Software & SaaS" Cost Pool.
	Other Operating	Other cloud services expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Hardware	**Includes all physical technology assets such as servers, PCs, storage arrays, network appliances, mobile devices, IP phones, and printers. Excludes property, office space, raised floor facilities, and infrastructure components like racks.**	
	Lease	Leasing costs for hardware, including payment structures for equipment acquired through leasing agreements.
	Maintenance & Support	Costs associated with maintaining and supporting hardware, including repairs and warranty services.
	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation and amortization of capitalized hardware investments.
	Managed Services	Managed service provider costs related to hardware operations and maintenance.
	Other Operating	Other hardware expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Software & SaaS	**Includes the licensing, maintenance, support, and SaaS costs for all software, including operating systems, middleware, databases, and applications.**	
	Licensing	Costs for software licenses and renewals. Excludes SaaS, maintenance, and support services.

Cost Pool	Cost Sub-Pool	Description
Software & SaaS (continued)	Maintenance & Support	Expenses for maintaining and supporting software, including updates and patches for existing licenses.
	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation and amortization of capitalized software costs over their accounting life.
	SaaS	Expenses for software provided as a service (SaaS), including cloud-hosted solutions.
	Other Operating	Other software and SaaS expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Data Center Facilities	**Includes the floor space, power, cooling, and other utilities costs, environmental controls (e.g., fire suppression), power distribution, and other related costs for managing data center facilities. Excludes personnel and hardware components like servers and storage.**	
	Lease	Leasing costs for data center facilities, including rental and associated operational expenses.
	Maintenance & Support	Costs associated with maintaining and supporting data center facilities, including repairs and upgrades.
	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation and amortization of capitalized data center facilities investments.
	Managed Services	Costs associated with an external service provider who takes responsibility for managing and maintaining an organization's data center facilities.
	Other Operating	Other data center facilities expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Telecom	**Includes all telecommunications charges, such as leased lines, domestic and international voice (including mobile), MPLS, ISP, and other network connectivity charges. Excludes mobile devices, IP phones, and related hardware expenses supported via the Hardware pool.**	
	Lease	Leasing costs for telecom infrastructure, including circuits and related equipment.
	Maintenance & Support	Expenses for maintaining and supporting telecom infrastructure, including repairs and upgrades.
	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation and amortization of capitalized telecom assets over their accounting life.
	Managed Services	Managed service provider costs for telecom-related services.

Cost Pool	Cost Sub-Pool	Description
Telecom (continued)	Other Operating	Other telecom expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Misc Costs	**Miscellaneous or non-standard expenses that do not fit within other defined cost pools, covering irregular or undefined expenditures.**	
	Managed Services	Managed service provider costs unrelated to any other Cost Pool.
	Other Operating	Miscellaneous or non-standard expenses that cannot qualify for another Cost Sub Pool or insufficient details are available to determine.
Cross Charges	**Costs incurred from other internal groups (eg HR, finance, facilities, and other Technology groups).**	
	By Internal Department	Costs incurred from other internal groups (e.g. HR, finance, facilities, and other Technology groups).
Capital Expenses (CapEx)		
Staffing	Internal Labor Capital	Capitalized internal labor costs related to technology services and project delivery.
	Staff Augmentation Capital	Capitalized costs for external labor services unrelated to headcount, supporting specific projects or initiatives.
Outside Services	Capital	Capitalized costs for external labor services unrelated to headcount, supporting specific projects or initiatives.
Cloud Services	Capital	Capitalized cloud services expenses.
Hardware	Capital	Capitalized hardware expenses.
Software & SaaS	Capital	Capitalized software & SaaS expenses.
Data Center Facilities	Capital	Capitalized data center facilities expenses.
Telecom	Capital	Capitalized telecom expenses (including capitalized telecom equipment and telecom infrastructure investments).
Misc Costs	Capital	Capitalized costs unrelated to any other Cost Pool.

Technology Resource Towers Layer

The **Technology Resource Towers** layer provides the standard classification of technology functions and domains that consume financial and operational resources. It sits between the **Cost Pools**—which identify the sources of technology spend—and the **Solutions** delivered by the Technology organization. In the TBM model, Towers organize costs into functional categories that describe how technology is operated, maintained, and supported. The complete structure of this hierarchy is shown in **Figure 4.**

TBM Taxonomy 5.0 Technology Resource Towers

INFRASTRUCTURE				APPLICATION		OPERATIONS				FIELD & OFFICE	
Data Center	**Storage**	**Compute**	**Network**	**Application**	**Data**	**Delivery**	**Tech Management**	**Security**	**Risk & Compliance**	**Smart Devices**	**End User**
Enterprise Data Center	Online Storage	Servers	LAN	Development	Data Operations	Service Management	Tech Management & Strategy	Digital Security	Regulatory & Audit	Intelligent Devices	Workspace
Other Facilities	Offline Storage	Converged Infrastructure	WAN	Support & Operations	Data Management	Client Management	Tech Finance	Identity & Access Governance	Risk Management	Industrial & Control Systems	Mobile Devices
	Mainframe Online Storage	High Performance Compute	Voice & Collaboration	Licensing	Mainframe Database	Operations Center	Enterprise Architecture		Disaster Recovery		Network Printers
	Mainframe Offline Storage	Mainframe	AI Network	Middleware	Database	Tech Portfolio & Project Management	Tech Vendor Management				Conferencing & AV
	AI Storage	AI Compute	Network Management	Mainframe Middleware		Central Print	Tech Human Capital Management				Help Desk
		Quantum		Container Orchestration							Deskside Support
		Serverless		Blockchain & Tokenization							
		Auto-Scalers		AI Models							

Figure 4: TBM Taxonomy Tower and Sub-Towers

Each Tower represents a major area of technology resource investment. To support clarity and comparability, all Towers are grouped into four Technology Resource Domains—high-level categories used only for organizing related Towers:

- **Infrastructure** – Encompasses core computing, storage, network, hosting, and platform-enablement functions.
- **Application** – Groups software-oriented Towers used to develop, operate, and manage enterprise applications.
- **Field & Office** – Includes distributed technologies used across end-user environments, field equipment, and on-site locations.
- **Operations** – Captures cross-functional support areas such as technology management, governance, and continuity services.

Towers Hierarchy

Hierarchy		Example
1. Domain	Optional for higher-level categorization	» Infrastructure
2. Tower	Standard TBM Taxonomy	» Compute
3. Sub-Tower		» Servers
4. Sub-Tower Element	Optional for more granular aggregation and allocation	» Windows » Linux
5. Tags	Optional metadata for filtering and analysis	» AI Enabled = Yes » Project ID = PRJ1234

Figure 5: TBM Taxonomy Towers Hierarchy

Each domain contains multiple Towers, which are organized hierarchically for improved visibility and standardization. As illustrated in Figure 5, the full structure includes:

- **Tower –** The foundational classification of a technology function (e.g., Compute, Application, End User).
- **Sub-Tower –** A more detailed grouping within a Tower (e.g., Servers, Mainframe, Licensing).
- **Sub-Tower Element (optional)** – Describes technical environment, architecture, or deployment model (e.g., On-Premise, Public Cloud).
- **Tags (optional) –** Metadata fields for enhancing reporting, modeling or filtering (e.g., Application ID, Project ID, Squad, Region).

Sub-Tower Elements and **Tags** are not required for TBM adoption or modeling. Their use is optional and organization-specific. When implemented, they offer greater granularity into deployment models, sourcing arrangements, or architectural attributes. Importantly, their inclusion does not affect benchmarking, which is standardized at the Tower and Sub-Tower levels.

Towers primarily reflect **direct costs**—those that can be directly assigned to specific technology functions, such as licensing fees, developer labor, disaster recovery services, or device provisioning. Depending on the organization's TBM model, **shared services** or **indirect costs** may also be associated with Towers through allocation methods. The taxonomy supports this flexibility while preserving structural consistency.

The following table defines the standard Towers and Sub-Towers used within the TBM Taxonomy.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Data Center	**Purpose-built facilities to securely house computer equipment. Data Centers provide racks/cabinets, clean & redundant power, data connectivity, environmental controls including temperature, humidity and fire suppression, physical security, and the people to run and operate the facility and its infrastructure.**	
	Enterprise Data Center	Purpose-built facilities providing centralized housing, physical security, and environmental controls for a variety of infrastructure components, including compute, storage, network, and converged systems, essential for enterprise-level operations.
	Other Facilities	Supporting facilities (eg computer rooms, telco closets) within corporate or remote locations to house essential technology equipment securely.
Storage	Centralized and scalable data storage used to support enterprise applications, databases, backups, and unstructured content. Includes high-availability and archival storage solutions deployed across on-premise, cloud, and mainframe environments. Excludes internal device storage integrated into servers, end user devices, and multifunction appliances.	
	Online Storage	Active storage resources like Storage Area Network (SAN) and Network Attached Storage (NAS), supporting centralized, high-availability data access across distributed environments, with configurations for on-premises or cloud storage.
	Offline Storage	Storage solutions for archiving, backup, and disaster recovery, used to protect data and ensure compliance in distributed storage environments, with limited access to enable secure long-term retention.
	Mainframe Online Storage	Online storage arrays dedicated to mainframe environments, providing necessary equipment and support for continuous mainframe operations.
	Mainframe Offline Storage	Storage resources dedicated to mainframe environments, supporting archiving, backup, disaster recovery, and compliance needs.
	AI Storage	High-performance storage resources designed to meet the speed and volume demands of AI workloads, supporting rapid data access and retrieval for machine learning and deep learning processes.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Compute	**Devices providing the processing capacity required to execute application logic, manage workflows, and support user transactions. Includes general-purpose and specialized compute resources across physical, virtual, and cloud environments in addition to all associated hardware, labor, and external services directly supporting compute infrastructure.**	
	Servers	Dedicated physical and virtual servers supporting essential applications and data processing needs across the organization. Includes related hardware, software, labor, and support resources. Excludes integrated multifunctional appliances like Converged Infrastructure.
	Converged Infrastructure	Integrated appliances combining compute, storage, and network functionalities within a single solution, designed for streamlined deployment in data centers or similar infrastructure locations.
	High Performance Compute	Advanced computing resources for scientific, engineering, and complex data simulations, optimized for parallel processing and intensive workloads outside AI-specific applications.
	Mainframe	Legacy mainframe systems running enterprise-grade applications and operations.
	AI Compute	Specialized compute resources with high-performance capabilities, including GPU-based servers, optimized explicitly for AI and machine learning workloads.
	Quantum	Dedicated compute resources engineered for quantum-native workloads such as quantum optimization, molecular modeling, or cryptographic simulation. Excludes classical or AI-oriented compute resources.
	Serverless	Abstracted compute services where infrastructure management is fully handled by the platform provider, and resources scale automatically based on demand. Designed for event-driven and stateless application workloads. Excludes traditional server-based or containerized compute.
	Auto-Scalers	Compute orchestration capabilities that dynamically scale virtual machines, containers, or services based on predefined performance thresholds. Includes infrastructure automation tools focused on right-sizing and elasticity of compute environments. Excludes standalone virtual servers or fully abstracted serverless platforms.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Network	**Infrastructure required to enable secure, high-speed data and voice connectivity across enterprise environments. Supports communication within and between data centers, office buildings, remote locations, and cloud platforms. Includes local and wide area networks, voice infrastructure, and specialized networking to support high-performance or workload-specific needs.**	
	LAN	Local Area Network infrastructure enabling high-speed, secure connectivity within office environments or data centers, facilitating reliable intra-office communication and device connections.
	WAN	Wide Area Network infrastructure supporting secure, high-speed connections across dispersed locations and data centers, specifically designed for long-distance inter-office communication and global data transport.
	Voice & Collaboration	Voice resources which enable or distribute voice services through on premise equipment including PBX, VoIP, voicemail, and handsets (excludes telecom and communication services).
	AI Network	Network infrastructure optimized for AI data transmission, enabling low-latency connections and high data throughput for AI-related tasks.
	Network Management	Resources and tools dedicated to the administration and oversight of network infrastructure, including IP addressing, DNS, DHCP, monitoring, telemetry, logging, and configuration management. Supports network visibility, health, and control across hybrid environments.
Application	**Encompasses the full lifecycle and operational support of software applications and the platforms that enable their execution, integration, and interoperability. Includes planning, development, licensing, and sustainment of business and technical applications, as well as internally built and externally acquired software, middleware, orchestration tools, and runtime environments that support scalable and connected software delivery.**	
	Development	Resources involved with the lifecycle of application development, including planning, design, coding, testing, and deployment packaging.
	Support & Operations	Resources for ongoing operations, maintenance, issue resolution, training, and minor updates of existing applications, ensuring consistent performance and reliability.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Application (continued)	Licensing	Software licensing and renewal expenses, including standard vendor entitlements such as patching rights, and version upgrades defined in the license terms.
	Middleware	Middleware resources supporting cross-platform application integration, communication, and information sharing.
	Mainframe Middleware	Middleware resources supporting application and system integration within mainframe environments, enabling data sharing and communication.
	Container Orchestration	Resources supporting container lifecycle management, including deployment, scaling, and monitoring for flexible application environments.
	Blockchain & Tokenization	Platforms for developing and managing blockchain applications, including tokenization solutions for secure and decentralized data and asset management.
	AI Models	Platforms and tools specifically designed for AI development and deployment, including machine learning frameworks and model orchestration.
Data	**Resources used to structure, manage, govern, and operationalize data assets. Includes databases, metadata, governance frameworks, and data operations that ensure data integrity, interoperability, and alignment to business and compliance requirements.**	
	Data Operations	Systems, tools, and resources that support enterprise data operations, including data quality, synchronization, interoperability, schema design, and file management. Also includes the acquisition and management of data subscriptions and the processing of high-volume or fast-moving data, particularly unstructured or semi-structured, used in operational workflows.
	Data Management	Resources involved in managing data and content across the enterprise, including Data Governance, Master Data Management, and Metadata Management. Includes establishing data/content management policies, standards, processes, and procedures and maintaining the enterprise information asset inventory and data set catalogue.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Data (continued)	Mainframe Database	Database resources dedicated to mainframe environments, supporting physical storage, management, and database administration.
	Database	Core database resources managing structured data storage and retrieval for applications, supporting data integrity, access, and administrative management for operational purposes.
Delivery	**Resources for the monitoring, coordination, governance, and continuous improvement of Technology operations. Includes service management, portfolio oversight, operational command centers, and supporting capabilities that ensure reliable and aligned delivery of Technology services.**	
	Service Management	Resources involved with the incident, problem, and change management activities as part of the Tech Service Management process (excludes the Tier 1 help desk). Also includes resources involved with designing, monitoring, reporting, and improving services, and the associated development/maintenance of service catalogs, service measures, and service agreements.
	Client Management	Resources focused on managing relationships with business partners, ensuring alignment with business requirements.
	Operations Center	Centralized operations for monitoring and intervention across global infrastructure, supporting stability and reliability.
	Tech Portfolio & Project Management	Resources supporting strategic portfolio management and investment in business and technical initiatives, covering project and product oversight, funding, and prioritization. Includes Solution Owners, Project/Program/Portfolio Managers, PMO, AMO, and related resources.
	Central Print	Centralized print resources supporting customer billing, documentation, and internal printing needs.
Tech Management	**Strategic, financial, organizational, and administrative resources that govern and support the Technology organization. Includes enterprise architecture, financial planning, talent management, vendor oversight, and executive leadership embedded in and supporting the Technology organization.**	
	Tech Management & Strategy	Resources supporting strategic planning, governance, and administration of the Technology organization. Includes CIO, CTO, Chief of Staff, senior Technology leaders, and administrative support.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Tech Management (continued)	Tech Finance	Financial management and TBM resources overseeing budgeting, spending, showback/chargeback, and solution costing.
	Enterprise Architecture	Architectural resources which standardize, integrate, and enhance efficiency across technology solutions, supporting enterprise-wide strategies.
	Tech Vendor Management	Vendor management resources focusing on contracts, performance, and delivery with external providers.
	Tech Human Capital Management	Resources embedded within the Technology organization and involved in the acquisition, development, performance management, compensation, and separation of Technology personnel. Included are initial and periodic personnel background investigations and drug testing, as well as training on organizational policies and procedures.
Security	**Resources that safeguard technology systems, data, and operations. Includes cybersecurity and disaster recovery planning to ensure protection, resilience, and continuity of Technology operations. Excludes risk management and compliance.**	
	Digital Security	Security resources dedicated to proactively protecting enterprise systems and data integrity through policy development, protective measures, real-time threat monitoring, and incident response.
	Identity & Access Governance	Resources managing digital identities, authentication, authorization, and governance of access rights (e.g., IAM solutions, privileged access management).
Risk & Compliance	**Resources supporting the identification, management, and fulfillment of Technology risk, regulatory, data privacy, and compliance obligations. Includes capabilities for risk assessment, audit readiness, legal compliance, and adherence to internal and external control frameworks.**	
	Regulatory & Audit	Systems and resources supporting compliance reporting, auditing, legal hold, data privacy, and regulatory submission requirements.
	Risk Management	Resources supporting identification, assessing, and mitigating technology, operational, and enterprise risks.
	Disaster Recovery	Resources dedicated to disaster recovery planning, policy setting, and testing to ensure organizational resilience and continuity.

Tower	Sub-Tower	Description
Smart Devices	**Resources supporting operational technology through sensor-based input, localized processing, and device-to-device or device-to-cloud communication across industrial, commercial, and workplace settings. Includes embedded, IoT-enabled, and edge-connected devices that monitor, automate, or interact with the physical environment.**	
	Intelligent Devices	Edge devices capable of local processing and limited decision-making based on sensor inputs (e.g., smart appliances, embedded controllers).
	Industrial & Control Systems	Specialized IoT devices and systems that manage or automate physical processes within industrial environments. Includes SCADA systems, PLCs, manufacturing control units, and operational sensors embedded in critical infrastructure.
End User	**Resources enabling individual productivity and day-to-day technology interaction. Includes user computing equipment, mobile technology, workspace devices, and centralized support channels such as help desks and deskside assistance.**	
	Workspace	Physical devices and peripherals supporting individual workspace needs. Includes physical desktops/laptops, thin client machines, and peripherals (eg monitor, mouse, personal printer, speakers, keyboard). Excludes software, labor, and support resources.
	Mobile Devices	Mobile devices supporting individual productivity and communication needs. Includes smart watches and other smart wearables.
	Network Printers	Network-connected printers and printing resources accessible to end users.
	Conferencing & AV	Equipment and resources for conferencing and audiovisual communication, supporting workforce collaboration.
	Help Desk	Centralized help desk supporting user requests and first-line issue resolution.
	Deskside Support	Support resources assisting with moves, setups, and issue resolution.

Technology Solutions Layer

Solutions represent the digital products, technology services, and business-facing capabilities delivered by Technology organizations and consumed by internal or external stakeholders. They are the focal point where value is planned, managed, and measured—linking technology costs and performance to business outcomes. Each Solution depends on a supply chain of technology resources, including infrastructure, applications, and labor, drawn from the Technology Resource Towers and managed across their lifecycle. **Figure 6** illustrates the Solutions Layer and its position within the TBM Taxonomy.

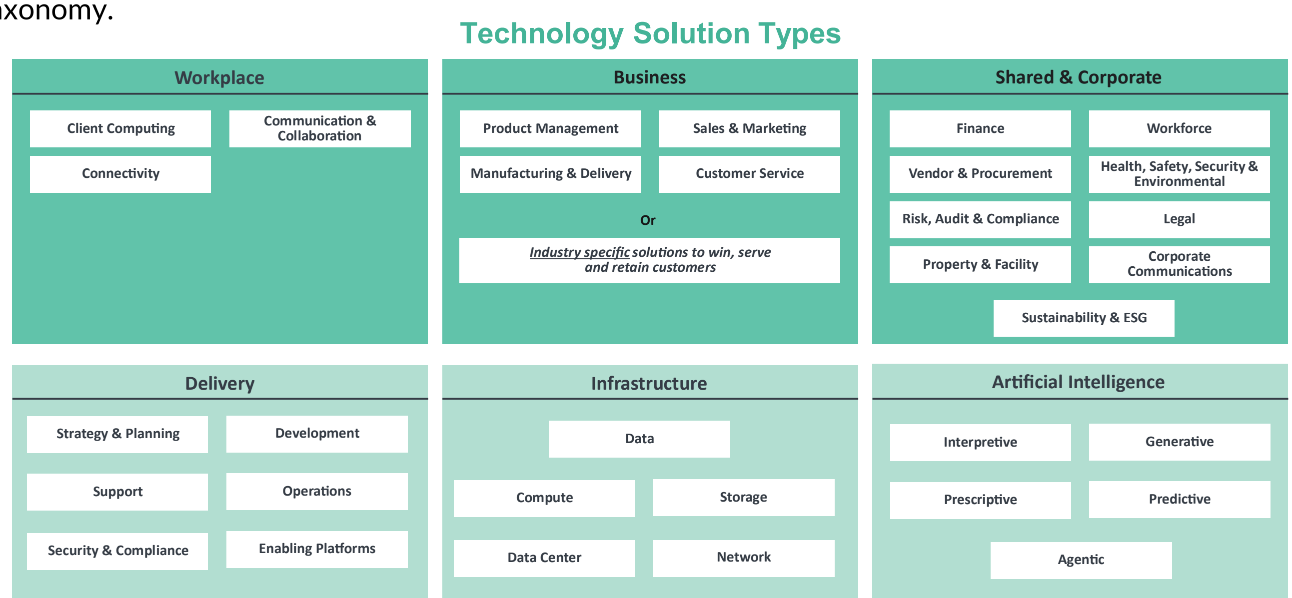


Figure 6: TBM Taxonomy Solutions, Type & Category View

In the TBM model, Solutions are where cost transparency becomes business relevance. They allow Technology organizations to align financial, operational, and architectural data to business capabilities, product lines, shared services, or customer-facing experiences. Solutions support planning, budgeting, benchmarking, and performance analysis across Business and Technology domains.

Products, Services, and Consumers

Solutions can represent either **products** or **services**, depending on their primary purpose, consumer, lifecycle, governance model, and delivery orientation:

Aspect	Product	Service
Primary Purpose	Deliver external or customer-facing value	Provide internal or shared capabilities
Orientation	Market- or outcome-based	Process- or capability-based
Governance	Often agile, owned by product managers	Often stable, managed via service owners
Consumption	Consumed by end users or clients	Consumed by internal teams or systems
Lifecycle	Governed by product lifecycle stages	Managed via service catalog lifecycle

Regardless of product or service classification, a well-defined Solution should convey **clear business value to stakeholders.** In practice, many organizations offer both internal-facing services (e.g., infrastructure or collaboration tools) and external-facing products (e.g., digital platforms or mobile applications). The TBM Taxonomy uses the term "Solutions" broadly to accommodate this range without enforcing rigid distinctions.

Consumers refer to the internal or external stakeholders who receive and depend on the Solutions delivered by the Technology organization. They may include business units, product lines, shared services, regional organizations, partners, or customers. Understanding who consumes a Solution is essential for aligning technology investments with strategic priorities.

The Solutions Layer consists of four hierarchical levels that support both standardization and customization. This structure is shown in **Figure 7**.

- **Type** – The top-level grouping of related Solutions (e.g., Workplace, Delivery, Infrastructure, Artificial Intelligence)
- **Category** – A functional area within the Type, such as Workforce, Enabling Platforms, or Data Management
- **Name** – A business capability or deliverable, such as Network Access, HR Management, or CRM Enablement
- **Offering** (user-defined) – A specific, identifiable product or service delivered by the Technology organization to meet a business or operational need.
- **Tags** (optional) – Metadata fields for additional insights or filtering (e.g., Classification, AI Enabled, Region, Consumer ID).

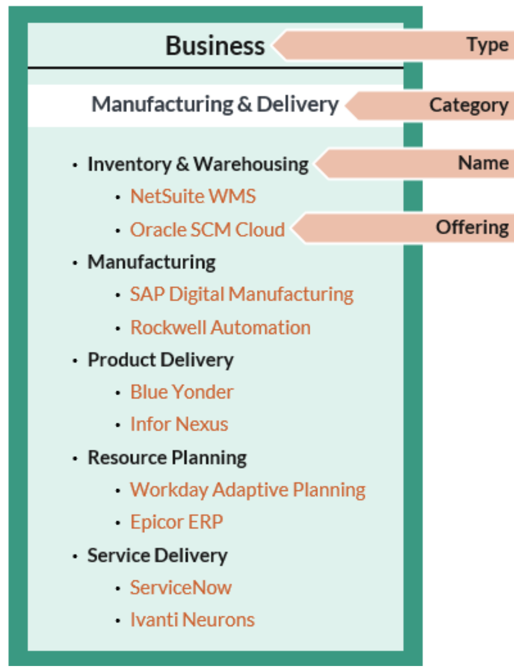


Figure 7: TBM Taxonomy Solutions Hierarchy

Offerings are defined by each organization and may reflect product SKUs, service catalog entries, or solution bundles tailored to stakeholder needs. Their inclusion is optional and does not affect taxonomy alignment.

Organizations may manage their Solutions through **product and/or service portfolios**. These portfolios often include stages such as pipeline, active catalog, and retired offerings—or track product maturity through stages such as evaluate, invest, extract, and sunset.

The TBM Taxonomy supports this flexibility. While standard Types, Categories, and Names are defined to promote consistency and benchmarking, organizations may customize, rename, extend, or reorganize their Offerings to reflect their operating model—so long as the four-tier hierarchy is respected. Official industry and vertical taxonomy extensions developed by the TBM Community are also available to guide customization in regulated or specialized domains.

The following tables define the current **Types, Categories,** and **Names** included in the TBM Taxonomy.

Delivery

Solutions supporting the development, deployment, operation, and sustainment of Workplace, Business, and Shared & Corporate solutions. This includes development services that create or modify business-facing capabilities and support operations that assist users and ensure solution availability and performance.

Category	Name	Description
Strategy & Planning	**Supports enterprise-wide planning, governance, and leadership of the organization's digital capabilities. Activities in this category include solution consulting, enterprise architecture, innovation and R&D, project and product delivery oversight, and partner/vendor management. It also encompasses strategic planning services traditionally associated with service management frameworks.**	
	Enterprise Architecture	Enterprise architecture guides organizations through the business, information, process, and technology changes necessary to execute their business and Technology strategies.
	Business Solution Consulting	Helps the enterprise improve their performance, primarily through the analysis of existing business problems and development of plans for improvement. This includes business relationship management, demand management, business process analysis as well as technology selection.
	Technology Business Management	Solutions supporting business-aligned technology decisions, including cost transparency, financial management, and value optimization.
	Innovation & Ideation	The investment, development, and incubation of new technologies to create new or better solutions which meet unarticulated or existing market needs. Includes new technology solutions and new product incubation solutions.
	Technology Vendor Management	The management of technology suppliers who provide, deliver and support technology products and solutions. Includes solutions across the life cycle of a vendor including selection, negotiation, contracting, procurement, maintenance and subscription renewals, and performance management.

Category	Name	Description
Strategy & Planning (continued)	Program, Product & Project Management	The process of managing software development-focused projects, programs, and products with the intention of improving an organization's performance.
Development	**Plan, design, build, test and release new solutions.**	
	Design & Development	Provides the planning, design, programming, documenting, testing, and fixing involved in creating and maintaining a software product.
	System Integration	Links together different computing systems and software applications physically or functionally, to act as a coordinated whole. This can be accomplished across systems that reside within the enterprise's data centers as well as with SaaS solutions that reside in the provider's facilities.
	Modernization & Migration	Provides the planning, design, and architecture for moving from older, often legacy systems and platforms to newer, more modern systems and platforms. Includes the migration of data, including user accounts, user data, configuration data and other datasets needed for operations in the new environment.
	Testing	Executes programs or applications with the intent of finding errors or other defects. The investigations are conducted to provide stakeholders with information about the quality of the product or solution and allow the business to understand the risks of software implementation. Testing may take multiple forms including functional, system, integration, performance, and usability.
Operations	**Monitor, support, manage, and run the enterprise technology systems for the enterprise. Typically provided behind the scenes and not directly user-facing.**	
	Deployment & Administration	Includes the release management and software distribution solutions to deploy new and/or the most recent software version to the host servers or client computing devices. Also includes ongoing operating system (OS) support and patch management.
	Tech Service Management	Solutions managing incidents, changes, and configurations, including ITSM tools, asset management, and operational tracking.
	Capacity Management	Solutions which ensure that resources are right sized to meet current and future business requirements in a cost-effective manner. Takes into account the

Category	Name	Description
Operations (continued)	Capacity Management (continued)	expected demand from the business or consumer along with the availability and performance of existing capacity and projects future requirements.
	Event Management	Solutions for monitoring resources and applications, recording events, and delivering actionable insights for system optimization.
	Scheduling	Solutions involved in the execution of tasks required to operate a Technology Service and are often automated using software tools that run batch or online tasks at specific times of the day, week, month or year.
Support	**Support the end user community with training, application support, service desk and central print services.**	
	Application Support	Provides the ongoing operational activities required to keep the application or solution up and running, provide Tier 2 and Tier 3 technical support to more complex or difficult user questions and requests. May also include minor development and validation of smaller application enhancements (e.g., minor changes, new reports).
	Central Print	Provides high-volume and advanced printing for invoices, product literature or other complex documents for mass distribution. May also include folding, envelope stuffing, postage and bundling to expedite distribution.
	Tech Training	Solutions providing structured training programs for users to effectively utilize technology resources, including software, tools, and systems.
	Service Desk	Centralized solutions for user support, troubleshooting, and issue resolution, delivered through multiple communication channels.
Security & Compliance	**Ensure the integrity, protection and proper use of the enterprises technology systems and data.**	
	Identity & Access Management	Manages digital identities and governs access to systems, data, and services to ensure the right individuals have the appropriate access at the right time. This includes establishing policies, controls, and technologies to support secure authentication, identity lifecycle management, role-based access, and administrative oversight.
	Security Awareness	Programs to educate and train employees on security policies and best practices to safeguard the organization’s physical and digital assets.

Category	Name	Description
Security & Compliance (continued)	Cyber Security & Incident Response	Delivers the capabilities, processes, and technologies to detect, assess, and respond to cybersecurity threats and incidents. This includes real-time monitoring, threat intelligence integration, and coordinated incident response to minimize impact and restore normal operations. Key focus areas include cybersecurity monitoring and security incident response.
	Threat & Vulnerability Management	Identifies, assesses, prioritizes, and mitigates security vulnerabilities across applications, infrastructure, networks, and endpoints to reduce the risk of exploitation. This capability supports continuous threat exposure management through proactive scanning, analysis, and remediation planning.
	Data Privacy & Security	Solutions to ensure the security and privacy of organizational and user data, including encryption, classification, and access controls.
	Governance, Risk & Compliance	Solutions for setting policies, controls, and compliance measures to address regulatory, legal, and business risk requirements.
	Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery	Solutions to ensure organizational resilience by restoring operations after disruptive events through disaster recovery capabilities, business continuity policies, and action plans.
Enabling Platforms	**Provide a range of solutions that host and enable other applications.**	
	Application Hosting	Solutions for hosting and managing applications and web environments, including server provisioning, scalability, and maintenance.
	Development Platform	Providing an environment and toolset for the efficient development, integration, and testing of applications or application solutions, including microservices. May include an integrated development environment (IDE) for source code editing, version control, build automation and debugging. May include low-code development platforms to support less technical developers to create working software or software features.
	Foundation Platform	Includes the core foundation capabilities provided by large ERP systems as well as the “platform as a service” provided by many SaaS applications. ERP foundation platforms (like SAP R/3 Basis or SAP S/4 HANA) are the technical underpinning that enables the ERP application to function.

Category	Name	Description
Enabling Platforms (continued)	Foundation Platform (continued)	Typically consists of programs and tools that support the interoperability and portability of ERP applications across systems and databases. Many SaaS applications also provide a platform capability to enable integration and development of additional applications or modules that complement the primary application suite. Examples include Salesforce's Force.com product, ServiceNow's Now Platform and Appian.
	Message Bus & Integration	Allows different systems to communicate through a shared set of interfaces. Includes event streaming to multiple applications, subscribe and publish notification solution for enterprise and mobile messaging, task completion alerts and threshold alerts.
	Content Management	Supports the creation and modification of digital content from supporting multiple users in a collaborative environment. Includes records management and digital asset management.
	Search	Provides keyword search functions for web and mobile applications.
	Streaming	Delivers live and on-demand media streams including audio and video.

Infrastructure

Foundational facilities, compute, storage, and network solutions delivered by the Technology organization and directly consumed.

Category	Name	Description
Compute	**Provide the physical and virtual computing systems that run applications, software tools and system services. Can be dedicated or on-demand and may be provided on-premises or through external managed services or public cloud offerings.**	
	Compute on Demand	Temporary, scalable compute solutions provisioned automatically in response to triggers or schedules, supporting dynamic workload requirements.
	Mainframe	Transactional and batch-oriented compute solutions supported by a mainframe infrastructure.
	Physical Compute	Variety of compute configurations comprised of physical servers. These are typically distributed compute solutions based on the Windows, Linux, or Unix operating systems for pre-defined configurations of memory, CPU, and storage. Standard operational support includes security hardening, backup, updates, patches, and centralized monitoring.
	Virtual Compute & Containers	Virtualized compute resources delivered on-demand, including containers for application, data, and workload portability.
Data Center	**Provide a secure and controlled environment for housing compute, storage, network, and other technology equipment.**	
	Enterprise Data Center	Facilities designed to securely house Technology equipment with physical security, redundant power, data connectivity, and environmental controls. Includes enterprise-owned, co-located, or service provider-operated data centers with additional services like shipping, assembly, and maintenance.
	Other Data Center	Other data center solutions that may be delivered through dedicated secure rooms or telecom closets with a facility.
Data	**Provide a variety of data-related services that capture and retrieve transactional activities in a database, store the data in a centralized data warehouse, provide analytical and visualization tools to explore the data and caching technology to distribute information to the edge to improve performance and response times.**	
	Database	Provides structured and unstructured data storage solutions to support application access, retrieval, and transaction processing.

Category	Name	Description
Data (continued)	Distributed Cache	An in-memory cache solution that helps improve web application performance.
	Data Management	A set of data analytic solutions that automate the movement and transformation of data including extract, transform and load (ETL) processes, data quality management and master data management.
	Data Warehouse	Provides a central repository or set of repositories of integrated data from one or more disparate sources. Stores current and historical data and are used for creating analytical reports for knowledge workers throughout the enterprise.
	Data Analytics & Visualizations	Provides software solutions and BI tools to analyze and communicate information clearly and efficiently to users via graphs, charts and other visual representations including geospatial analytics. Also includes real-time streaming analysis of data by providing low latency, highly available, scalable complex event processing over streaming data in the cloud.
Network	**Provide the voice and data network and supporting services such as load balancing, domain services, virtual private network, and the internet to enable communications within and outside the enterprise.**	
	Domain Solutions	Lookup capabilities to convert domain names (e.g., www.acme.com) into the associated IP address to enable communication between hosts.
	Internet Connectivity	Telecommunication solutions using the public internet to enable communications across the organization including its data centers, office buildings, remote locations, partners, and service providers. Virtual Private Networks may be created to limit access and provide security.
	Load Balancing	Optimizes incoming application/workload requests through load balancing and traffic management to deliver high availability and network performance to applications.
	Virtual Private Network	Offers a secure method to authenticate users and enable access to corporate systems and information. May also isolate and secure environments in the data center across physical and virtual machines and applications.

Category	Name	Description
Network (continued)	Data Network	A selection of network connection offerings that enable direct data communications across the organization including its data centers, office buildings, remote locations as well as partners and service providers (including public cloud service providers) without traversing the public internet. Typically provides a greater level of performance, security, and control.
	Voice Network	Voice circuits to deliver "plain old telephone service" and other advanced features including 800-services, automatic call distribution, voicemail and more. May include terrestrial and non-terrestrial (e.g., satellite) voice communication technologies.
Storage	**Persist information, data, files, and other object types ranging from real-time, high-performance data storage to long-term archive storage. Different offerings also provide recovery point objectives to meet the business needs of an application based on a business impact assessment.**	
	File & Object Storage	Secure and durable object storage where an object can be unstructured data such as documents and media files or structured data like tables.
	Backup & Archive	Secure storage solutions for data backup and long-term archiving, including disk, tape, and cloud-based options.
	Networked Storage	Provides a pool of storage to a server for the purposes of hosting data and applications, or to a virtualization environment for the purposes of hosting servers. Networked Storage solutions enable redundancy, ease of management, rapid move/add/change/delete capabilities, and economies of scale. Storage array network (SAN), network attached storage (NAS) and solid state drives (SSD) storage are example technologies.
	Distributed Storage (CDN)	Stores and serves high-bandwidth content at the edge network to reduce latency and improve application performance.

Workplace

User-facing solutions that deliver access, communication, and productivity tools (e.g. client devices, software, and connectivity) to support day-to-day workforce operations.

Category	Name	Description
Client Computing	**Provide physical and virtual devices and associated software and connectivity that enable users to interact with the enterprise's technology systems and third-party systems.**	

Category	Name	Description
Client Computing (continued)	Bring Your Own Device	Enables users to bring in their own personal computing devices (laptop, tablet, smartphone) and connect to the organization's corporate network in accordance with the organization's security and other standards. Standard support may include connectivity to access applications, information, and other technology resources, as well as other security, back-up, updates and patches, remote access, and centralized service desk.
	Computer	Computers, workstations, laptop, tablet, and similar devices.
	Mobile	Mobile phones and smartphones.
	Virtual Client	The virtualization of desktop and application software enables PC and tablet functionality to be separate from the physical device used to access those functions – whether a fixed or mobile workspace environment. Virtual Workspaces may have different, pre-configured packages of software application and enable access from multiple devices. Advanced desktop management provides higher levels of flexibility, security, backup, and disaster recover capabilities.
Communication & Collaboration	**Allow end users to communicate with other people via email or chat, to collaborate through shared workspaces, and to create and print content such as documents, presentations, videos, and other forms.**	
	Collaboration	Collaborative tools enabling teamwork and document sharing across distributed teams, supporting real-time and asynchronous communication to achieve shared goals.
	Communication	Solutions enabling communication through email, messaging, conferencing, and voice calls, supporting internal and external collaboration.
	Print	A variety of peripheral devices that enable the distribution of information. Specialized devices may offer one or all these solutions - print, copy, and fax. Printing output creates a "hard copy" of digital documents, presentations, spreadsheets, etc. Scan inputs a hardcopy document into a digital format for a computer to use.
	Productivity	End user application software enabling the creation and distribution of information in a variety of formats including documents, presentations, spreadsheet, modeling tools, project management, databases, desktop publishing, web design, graphics and image editing, audio/video editing and CD/DVD recording.

Category	Name	Description
Connectivity	**Provide users with access to the enterprise's technology systems. This includes wired and wireless access while on premise and remote access while away from the enterprise.**	
	Network Access	A set of connection solutions which enable users to access a private or public network from their client computing device. Once connected, as part of the network they can access applications and information; and can communicate and collaborate with other users on the network. Often, this may be bundled with a Client Computing solution.
	Remote Access	A set of connection solutions which enable users to access the organization's internal private network from their client computing device when away from the corporate facilities. Once connected, the user can access the organization's applications and information. Often, this may be bundled with a Client Computing solution.

Business

Solutions enabled by the Technology organization to support business capabilities (e.g. product management, customer engagement, and service delivery) that help the enterprise win, serve, and retain customers.

Category	Name	Description
Product Management	**Enables the planning, design, and development of products that deliver business or customer value. This category includes capabilities for managing product roadmaps, gathering requirements, coordinating cross-functional development, and supporting iterative delivery and lifecycle optimization.**	
	Product Development	Enables product design and development including innovation management, computer aided design, simulation visualization, enterprise feedback, and social product feedback and crowdsourcing.
	Product Planning	Enables product life-cycle management including requirements management, product data management, change and configuration management, manufacturing process management, quality management, product analytics, and risk and compliance management.
Sales & Marketing	**Drives customer engagement, demand generation, and revenue growth through data-driven insights, targeted outreach, and sales execution. This category includes capabilities for marketing automation, advertising, customer and product analytics, direct and channel sales management, and digital or in-person selling across B2B and B2C models.**	
	Customer Analytics	Solutions providing insights into customer behavior, preferences, and trends to drive strategic decisions.

Category	Name	Description
Sales & Marketing (continued)	Customer Sales	Enables B2C commerce platforms, B2B commerce platforms, product configurations, POS platforms and payments.
	Marketing & Advertising	Enables marketing automation, online marketing, mobile marketing, and ad technologies.
	Sales Force & Channel Management	Enables sales force automation, sales enablement and training, partner relationship management and pricing management.
Manufacturing & Delivery	**Supports the production and fulfillment of goods and services across physical and digital channels. This category includes capabilities for inventory and warehouse management, production and fabrication, logistics and delivery execution, service workforce deployment, and forward-looking resource planning across supply and demand cycles.**	
	Inventory & Warehousing	Solutions supporting inventory tracking, supply chain scheduling, warehouse management, and returns management.
	Manufacturing	Solutions enabling the planning, scheduling, and execution of manufacturing processes, including equipment maintenance and production quality assurance.
	Product Delivery	Solutions focused on managing logistics, fleet/transportation, supply-demand matching, and delivery tracking for physical products.
	Service Delivery	Enables the delivery of nontangible solutions including resource scheduling, engagement management, professional services, education, and service quality.
	Resource Planning	Solutions supporting the scheduling and delivery of non-tangible services, such as professional services and customer engagements.
Customer Service	**Enables organizations to support, manage, and fulfill customer needs across service interactions and transaction lifecycles. Capabilities in this category span order intake and fulfillment, as well as omnichannel customer care, including issue resolution, knowledge delivery, and field service enablement.**	
	Order Management	Solutions for managing order lifecycles, including contract management, pricing optimization, billing, and payment processing.
	Customer Care	Solutions enabling customer communication, issue resolution, and support through multi-channel platforms, including knowledge bases, workforce automation, and field service management.

Shared & Corporate

Solutions enabled by the Technology organization to support internal business functions and enterprise operations. These solutions typically automate or enhance shared service functions such as Finance, Human Resources, Legal, and other administrative domains that sustain the organization's core operating model.

Category	Name	Description
Finance	**Enable the financial management of the enterprise.**	
	Planning & Management Accounting	Enables the strategic allocation of funds in support of established future and current business goals, including planning, budgeting and forecasting, ad-hoc analysis and reporting to inform and guide leadership in the ongoing determination and understanding of business strategy related financial goals, incentives, progress and impact.
	Revenue Accounting	Enables the comparison of revenue targets to actual achievement. Supervisory responsibility over all transactions and entries (receivables, payables, intercompany movements) that pass into the final periodic accounts of an entity, and support int./ext. analysis and communication of profit on a monthly, quarterly, or annual basis. (Determination of whether this includes the actual lifecycle processing of payments due from customers, is based on entity type, sector, and scale - see Accounts Receivable).
	Accounts Receivable	Enables the complete lifecycle of invoicing and receipts processing to ensure the business is paid by its customers, including Invoicing, payment receipt, processing, error handling, PO setup (as a supplier) reconciliation, reporting and collections.
	General Accounting & Reporting	Enables financial statement preparation (balance sheet, statements of income, cash flows, shareholders' equity etc.) in accordance with accepted accounting principles. Also includes responsibilities to classify, determine, analyze, interpret, consolidate, and communicate financial information to support up-to-date business decisions for better management & control, and regulatory/legislative compliance (in conjunction with Management Accounting) of costs, assets & equipment. In certain contexts, can include grant activities related to the funding and reporting of non-repayable funds provided to corporate, academic or agency entities.

Category	Name	Description
Finance (continued)	Project Accounting	Solutions that enable managing accounts for large investment projects, often requiring significant capital outlays over multiple years. Managing investment against major milestone, product or activity expenditures during the course of a project, supporting project, portfolio and program leadership with insight to understand their progress & efficiency toward target.
	Payroll & Time Reporting	Enables the handling of reported time, and the ongoing processing and payment of wages, salaries, and benefits, including quality assurance and error handling (but excl. benefits management). Also inclusive of time keeping, and the capture, aggregation, measurement, validation, and transmission of staff time.
	Accounts Payables & Expense Reimbursement	Solutions to manage outgoing payments to suppliers and reimbursements to employees, including invoice processing and payment issuance.
	Treasury	Enables the management and optimization of daily liquidity, excess cash, and financial risk via investment activities (e.g. hedging, debt instrument purchase/sale, overnight and short-term institutional investments, and funds transfers) focused on supporting ongoing business operations across the entire company, or regionally. Also includes the governance, control, assessment, and risk management activities required to ensure effectiveness.
	Tax	Enables managing the organization's financial accounts specific to the world-wide management, optimization and payment of tax, and related evidence & documentation. This includes, planning, estimations & analysis of the tax position and impact, related transfer pricing strategies, tax return preparation, timely payment, and required authorizations. It also encompasses the orchestration of record retention in support of regulatory requirements and internal policy.
Workforce	**Enables management of the employees and contractors of the business or organization. In the broadest terms, it includes the activities to select, recruit, develop, reward, retain, counsel, and retire employees. Includes the management of employee information including workforce analytics.**	

Category	Name	Description
Workforce (continued)	Recruitment	Enables determining and handling employee recruiting, sourcing, and selection, including requirements gathering; advertising; order creation; agency placement; application receipt, review, filtering; candidate & agency contact; applicant screening & investigations; offering & negotiations; records management. Can also include prior employees.
	Employee Transitions & Separation	Enables managing employee (and less commonly vendor staff) transitions of a vertical, horizontal, geographic, mission, or structural nature, including management & administration of programs for: foreign assignment, reassignment, re-deployment, promotion/demotion, separation, outplacement, leave of absence, repatriation, and retirement.
	Workforce Management	Enables managing employee focused processes and information for workforce analysis & reporting; inquiry & resolution; employment verification; HR data / information; refreshing / updating indicators of employee retention and motivation, working with time & attendance systems (excluding items like actual survey or assessment delivery).
	Performance, Retention & Rewards Management	Enables creating frameworks for, and performing the management & administration of, programs for rewarding, motivating, and recognizing employees with the objective of retaining them and enabling career path growth (incl. distributions).
	Benefits Management	Enables the management, administration & processing of employee benefits, benefit plans, staff enrollment, claims, funding & entitlements; and includes analysis and planning, provider selection, employee communications & education, and regulatory compliance.
	Policy Management	Solutions for creating, maintaining, and enforcing policies to govern workforce behavior, compliance, and operational standards.
	Employee Development	Enables employees (and less commonly contractors/providers), with skills, knowledge, and/or capability development, and education. This extends to new hire onboarding / orientation; technical or business skills training; safety, security, conduct, ethics & compliance training; procedural and other legal or organizational aspects. (Excludes education as part of employee Transitions). Also includes program & course creation, delivery, management, and reporting.

Category	Name	Description
Workforce (continued)	Employee Communications & Relations	Enables crafting and execution of employee communications plans, its supporting messages, distribution channels and formats, to initiate interaction for: promoting horizontal or vertical employee engagement across the organization; creating awareness (e.g. of new policy, practices, or other internal / external events or actions of relevance); assessing satisfaction and engagement levels and drivers.
Vendor & Procurement	**Enable the procurement of goods and services required for a business to enable its activity including development of sourcing strategies, vendor selection, contract negotiations, ordering of materials & services and ongoing vendor and contract management.**	
	Sourcing and Procurement	Enables creating strategies, standards, and processes for procuring goods and services from approved sources. Establishes a procurement process that describes the approach, policy, and guidelines for purchasing activities including evaluation & sourcing of suppliers. Creates sourcing relationships to continuously improve price performance. Re-evaluates and assesses of purchasing activities, standards, pricing and impact across the value chain and supplier landscape.
	Supplier Management	Enables evaluating supplier options to select the most effective, efficient, and low risk suppliers. Validates selected suppliers. Use internal/external data, analysis, and feedback to rank and manage strategic and non-strategic suppliers to optimize vendor spend and output, including the ongoing management and reporting of supplier performance (e.g. output quality, delivery cycle times). May also include survey and research activities.
	Contract Management	Enables the intake and management of vendor contracts. Keeping contracts current with routine evaluation. Ensure proactive dissemination of knowledge to key stakeholders regarding renewals, expirations, price changes, volume thresholds or other contract aspects, to provide adequate lead times and avoid lapses in service, or surprise / unplanned expenditures.
Health, Safety, Security, and Environmental	**Enables management to provide a safe environment for the organization, environment and residents including policy, oversight, healthcare, occupational safety, and threat assessment.**	

Category	Name	Description
Health, Safety, Security, and Environmental (continued)	Policy & Governance	Enables determining the desired outcomes, obligations, conduct, and impacts related to personal and environmental health and safety. Creating and implementing the HSSE program. Train and educate employees on the HSSE program. Oversee and manage the HSSE program.
	Oversight & Enforcement	Enables monitoring and oversight of policy adherence and enforcement activities (including investigations) related to environmental, health and safety standards, should activity fall outside of defined processes, regulations, or legislation.
	Healthcare Services	Enables the definition and structuring of health services provided to/by the workforce, to promote preventative health and basic treatment, including the provision of on-site health services.
	Occupational Safety	Enables the programmatic evaluation and management of risks & opportunities that may affect industry-specific or role-related personal health and safety of employees, contractors, or other third parties. Provide required compliance and reporting as required by local and national governing bodies.
Risk, Audit & Compliance	**Enables management to proactively measure and mitigate the risk of the business and ensure adherence to regulatory requirements.**	
	Risk Management	Enables establishing umbrella frameworks, management activities, policy and related procedures and requirements for the entire organization, to defend against risks that may negatively impact the viability, growth, performance, health, stability, competitiveness, preparedness, or reputation of an ongoing concern, state, product or service. Ensures the identification, detection, assessment, monitoring and communication of risk and the execution of risk management activities across all levels of the organization, including all risk facets, including but not limited to sector, organization, operations, compliance, data, personal privacy, cyber, espionage, geo-political, etc.
	Breach Management & Remediation	Enables administering the efforts and activities for breach assessment / estimation of impact and causality, as well as containment and remediation efforts. This may require the creation of plans for corrective action, even in collaboration with government agencies and pertinent professional services firms specialized in remediation efforts relevant to the organization's operations.

Category	Name	Description
Risk, Audit & Compliance (continued)	Breach Management & Remediation (continued)	Includes generation of new recommendations for implementation by Risk Management to be embedded as part of the ongoing capability/process.
	Business Continuity Planning & Management	Solutions focusing on assessing business impact, creating resilience strategies, and conducting preparedness training to mitigate risks before disruptions occur.
	Auditing	Enables the internal or external planning, preparation, execution and review of internal control mechanisms, policies, and procedures in order to manage internal controls. Includes observation, reviews, interviews, fact-finding and the generation of recommendations and designs of control activities to be implemented. Monitor and review control effectiveness, remediate control deficiencies, and enable compliance functions. Can also include the implementation and maintenance of technologies and tools to enable internal controls-related activities.
	Investigations	Enables following up on a breach of standard operating procedures to identify, locate and understand the impact of the breach. An investigation can include searching, research, interviews, evidence collection, data preservation and various methods of investigation, as well as the gathering and documentation of findings & observations, and reporting of them.
	Records Management	Enables managing codified information in an organization throughout its life cycle and state/form, from the time of creation or inscription to its access and eventual disposition. This includes identifying, classifying, storing, securing, retrieving, tracking, and destroying or permanently preserving records, including digital and physical.
Legal	**Enables legal counsel to support the organization's governance and operations including discovery, litigation, contract reviews and intellectual property protection.**	
	Legal Counsel	Enables guidance and legal practices to abide by the law involving the practical application of legal theories, laws, regulations, and knowledge to govern the organization's messaging, product, and business operations. This includes the safeguarding (incl. litigation) and defense of intellectual property, brand value, confidential information, corporate and personal exposure to liability (physical or environment injury, cyber etc.) and many other forms and applications of law.

Category	Name	Description
Legal (continued)	Case Management	Enables managing the (mostly) administrative lifecycle of legal cases, including matter management, time and billing, document completion and submittal, monitoring case status, scheduling hearings and meetings, time and billing, orchestration of litigation support, collaboration and communications, record storage and search.
	Contract Review	Enables reviewing and negotiating terms to reach a final draft of a contract that is acceptable to all parties. Contracts may include non-disclosure agreements, master service agreements, statements of work and other types of contracts.
Property & Facility	**Enables management to provide the facilities for the organization including development & space planning, physical security, workplace services, fleet management (non-logistics), food services and the maintenance of facilities and equipment.**	
	Development & Space Planning	Enables planning the use, services, acquisition, and construction or build out, of non-performing or performing real property (whether owned or leased) for the organization. Execution of the planning, approvals, and acquisition of a site, for the build out or installation of real property or assets that may or may not yield direct income or house staff, equipment, or inventory. Creation of long-term vision, strategies, and standards for acquiring, developing, and managing purchased / leased / retained property and improvements.
	Workspace Solutions	Enables provisioning workspaces and related assets, and management of that provisioning effort. The orchestration and/or installation of office, shared community or light industrial spaces according to requirements (e.g. tables, chairs, couches, monitors, AV equipment, privacy screens, cubicles, doors, appliances, lighting, cabling, shelving, racks etc.). *Not intended for large scale industrial/plant construction.* Excludes Physical Security.
	Physical Security	Solutions managing the physical security of assets and people through barriers, access controls, and monitoring systems.
	Operations, Maintenance, Repair & Improvements	Enables preserving and improving productive assets through the planning, managing, and performance of preventative, routine, and critical maintenance work, and occasional improvements to those existing facilities or equipment.

Category	Name	Description
Property & Facility (continued)	Fleet Management (non-logistics)	Enables managing vehicles used to support the transportation of the workforce and may include vehicle financing, maintenance, telematics, and scheduling. Vehicles may include cars, vans, trucks, motorized carts, bicycles, and other forms of transportation. Does not include transportation associated with the shipment of the organization's products or service delivery.
	Food & Beverage	Enables providing and managing on-site food and beverage services for consumption by the organization's workforce.
Corporate Communications	**Enables management to orchestrate internal and external communications aimed at creating a favorable view among stakeholders including public relations, stakeholder relations, government relations, external relations, and community outreach.**	
	Stakeholder Relations	Enables fostering external relationships with stakeholders of the entity, including investors, government and industry, the board of directors, and the public. This is not related to customer management.
	Government Relations	Enables creating and maintaining relationships with government and industry representatives. Persuading public and government policy at the local, regional, national, and global level (subject to government regulations).
	External Communications	Enables developing and managing relations with media. Develop connections with journalists to solicit critical, third-party endorsements for a product, issue, service, or organization.
	Community Outreach	Solutions to foster community engagement, support outreach programs, and build organizational goodwill through local and global initiatives.
Sustainability & ESG	**Allow organizations plan, measure, manage, and report on their environmental, social, and governance (ESG) objectives. These solutions support compliance with regulatory frameworks, achievement of sustainability goals, and alignment with stakeholder expectations across climate, equity, and ethical domains.**	
	Carbon Accounting & Emission Reporting	Tracks, calculates, and reports greenhouse gas emissions across Scope 1, 2, and 3 sources to support regulatory compliance, corporate disclosures, and carbon reduction initiatives.
	ESG Data Integration	Aggregates and normalizes Environmental, Social, and Governance data from internal systems and external sources to support ESG scoring, analytics, and reporting.

Category	Name	Description
Sustainability & ESG (continued)	Supplier Sustainability Monitoring	Evaluates and tracks supplier performance on sustainability metrics such as emissions, labor practices, and resource usage to ensure alignment with ESG goals and responsible sourcing policies.
	Sustainability Performance Dashboarding	Provides real-time visualizations and analytics for key sustainability and ESG indicators, enabling transparency, executive reporting, and performance tracking against strategic goals.

Artificial Intelligence

Solutions enabling scalable, adaptive capabilities that enhance productivity, decision-making, and experience. Through technologies such as generative models, agent-based automation, and predictive intelligence, these solutions reduce manual effort, surface actionable insights, and optimize business and operational performance.

Category	Name	Description
Agentic	**Operate autonomously or semi-autonomously to execute tasks, coordinate systems, or pursue goals based on high-level input. They often combine planning, memory, reasoning, and interaction capabilities.**	
	Autonomous Navigation	Enables physical or digital systems to perceive environments, plan routes, and navigate independently using sensor data and real-time decision-making.
	Autonomous Workflow Agent	Performs rule-based and adaptive actions across business or technical workflows with limited or no human intervention, based on goals, context, or learned behavior.
	Intelligent Process Automation (IPA)	Combines robotic process automation with machine learning and analytics to automate multi-step business processes and adapt to changes in context or inputs.
Generative	**Create new content, artifacts, or data based on learned patterns. These systems can produce text, code, images, simulations, and other outputs—often enabling new user experiences, accelerating development, or enhancing creativity and ideation.**	
	Image & Video Generation	Creates synthetic visual content using AI techniques such as generative adversarial networks (GANs) or diffusion models, supporting design, simulation, and media production use cases.
	Speech, Music, and Audio Generation	Generates human-like or stylized audio content, including voice, sound effects, and music, using trained AI models to support creative, accessibility, or automation scenarios.

Category	Name	Description
Generative (continued)	Synthetic Data Generation	Creates artificial datasets that replicate the statistical properties of real data, used for training, testing, privacy protection, or bias mitigation in machine learning workflows.
	Text Generation	Produces human-like or domain-specific written content using language models, supporting tasks such as summarization, content drafting, translation, or conversational output.
Interpretive	**Extract meaning and structure from unstructured data such as language, images, and audio. These solutions enable classification, tagging, recognition, and contextual understanding, forming the foundation for many intelligent interfaces and analytics capabilities.**	
	Computer Vision	Enables machines to interpret and act on visual inputs such as images or video by detecting objects, classifying content, and understanding spatial relationships.
	Document Processing	Uses AI to extract, classify, and structure information from unstructured or semi-structured documents such as forms, invoices, or contracts.
	Natural Language Processes	Supports the interpretation and transformation of human language, including language translation, entity extraction, sentiment analysis, and intent detection.
	Speech Recognition & Processing	Converts spoken language into structured text and identifies characteristics such as speaker, emotion, or command intent in real time or recorded audio.
Predictive	**Applies statistical models and machine learning to forecast future outcomes, behaviors, or risks based on historical and real-time data. Solutions in this category help anticipate events, such as equipment failures or customer actions, to inform proactive decisions and mitigate risk.**	
	Predictive Analytics	Applies statistical and machine learning techniques to identify patterns and forecast future outcomes based on historical and real-time data.
	Predictive Maintenance	Forecasts equipment or asset failures using sensor data and usage patterns to optimize maintenance scheduling and reduce unplanned downtime.
	Risk Scoring	Generates probabilistic assessments of risk across domains such as fraud, compliance, credit, or security, using historical data and predictive modeling.

Category	Name	Description
Prescriptive	**Uses optimization techniques, rules engines, and AI-driven decision logic to recommend or automate the best course of action in complex scenarios. This category focuses on improving operational efficiency and strategic planning through automated recommendations and scenario-based planning.**	
	Automated Planning & Scheduling	Uses AI to dynamically generate and adjust task plans, workforce schedules, or resource allocations to optimize time, capacity, or efficiency.
	Decision Optimization	Identifies the most effective course of action among alternatives by modeling constraints, goals, and trade-offs using mathematical optimization or AI techniques.
	Recommendation Service	Delivers personalized content, products, or actions to users or systems by analyzing preferences, context, and behavior patterns in real time.

Technology Consumer Layer

The **Technology Consumer Layer** of the TBM Taxonomy identifies who consumes technology Solutions—and by extension, who evaluates, influences, and ultimately determines the business value delivered by the Technology organization. It connects the outputs of Technology (products, services, and capabilities) to the internal functions, value streams, partners, and external consumers that rely on them. **Figure 8** illustrates this layer's role in mapping value realization.

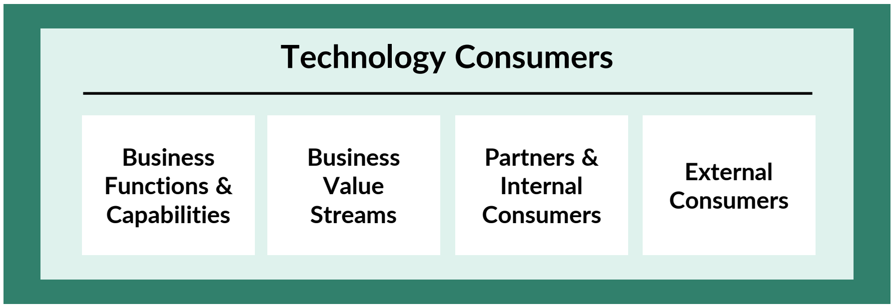


Figure 8: TBM Taxonomy Solution Consumers

This layer does not drive allocations within the TBM model. Instead, it **relies on upstream allocations**—from Cost Pools through Technology Resource Towers and Solutions—to surface cost, consumption, and performance information that can be attributed to specific stakeholders. It is essential for enabling showback, chargeback, and investment planning tied to business impact.

The taxonomy does not prescribe specific business functions, value streams, or consumer types. These elements must reflect the unique structure and strategy of each organization. Similarly, organizations may determine the appropriate level of granularity for representing their internal and external consumers, depending on their TBM use cases.

The following table defines the standard objects included in the Technology Consumer Layer:

Entities	Description
Business Functions & Capabilities	Formal organizational units responsible for running the enterprise, such as Finance, HR, Marketing, Sales, Customer Service, or Lines of Business. These often align to departments or cost centers and provide a stable view of organizational accountability.
Business Value Streams	Cross-functional flows of work that deliver value to customers or internal stakeholders—such as "Customer Onboarding," "Claims Processing," or "Product Fulfillment." Value streams typically span multiple functions and align with product or process-based delivery models.
Partners & Internal Consumers	Internal users or partner entities that consume technology services or digital products directly. Includes shared services recipients, federated business teams, and internal customers. Useful for consumption modeling, chargeback, and optimization.
External Consumers	Individuals or organizations outside the enterprise who consume technology-enabled products or services. May include end customers, clients, or public sector constituents. Modeling external consumers supports analysis of digital value, experience, and business impact.

Implementing the Taxonomy

The TBM Taxonomy provides a common structure for describing technology costs, resources, and business value. While its core elements are standardized to enable benchmarking and shared understanding, the taxonomy is designed to accommodate the diverse needs of organizations across industries, geographies, and operating models.

Organizations may tailor their implementation of the taxonomy in several supported ways:

- **Omit taxonomy objects that don't apply to your environment.**

  For example, if your organization does not operate a Mainframe, you may choose not to use the corresponding Sub-Tower. Similarly, if a service like Disaster Recovery is consumed through bundled hosting fees and cannot be isolated, you may choose not to use that Sub-Tower.

- **Apply taxonomy objects to alternative parts of your Technology estate.**

  Some categories are intentionally flexible. For instance, the Servers Sub-Tower can represent physical servers in your data center, virtual machines in private clouds, or infrastructure services in a public cloud (e.g., EC2 instances in AWS or virtual machines in Azure). You don't need to allocate to all compute types—just those that are relevant and measurable in your environment.

- **Use optional Sub-Tower Elements or Tags for more granularity.**

  If you want to distinguish between public and private cloud costs, or between applications, projects, regions, platforms, or business units, you can do so using Sub-Tower Elements or Tags. These constructs allow for internal flexibility without altering the underlying structure of the taxonomy and without impacting benchmarking at the Tower or Sub-Tower level.

- **Adopt only the modeling depth that aligns to your maturity.**

  Some organizations begin by aligning costs to Cost Pools and allocating to Sub-Towers. Others focus on mapping infrastructure and applications to Solutions first, then incorporate Sub-Tower Elements and tags to refine cost transparency over time. The taxonomy is structured to support phased adoption without loss of comparability.

- **Combine elements from different taxonomy versions to support phased adoption.**

  Organizations may choose to implement newer components of the taxonomy alongside existing ones. For example, you can continue using Cost Pools and Technology Resource Towers from version 4.1 while adopting the updated Solutions Layer from version 5.0. This approach allows you to take advantage of new capabilities without requiring a complete rebuild of your existing TBM model.

These modifications preserve the integrity of the taxonomy. However, certain changes are not supported:

- Do **not split** a standard taxonomy element into multiple new objects. For example, subdividing the **Licensing** Sub-Pool into internal vs. vendor-owned licenses breaks alignment with the standard structure. However, similar splits may be accomplished using tags.
- Do **not combine** multiple unrelated taxonomy objects into one. For instance, consolidating **Servers and Online Storage** into a custom "Core Infrastructure" category would compromise comparability and clarity.

- Do **not repurpose** taxonomy objects with alternate definitions or internal naming conventions. If internal reporting calls for a different label, use Tags to capture that information separately.

The TBM Taxonomy is most effective when organizations adapt it through selective use and optional layering—not by redefining its structure. This approach enables flexibility for internal reporting while preserving consistency for benchmarking, peer alignment, and TBM maturity progression.

Extending the TBM Taxonomy

While the standard TBM Taxonomy is designed to serve organizations across industries, some enterprises may require greater specificity to reflect their sector, regulatory environment, or specialized delivery models. In these cases, the taxonomy may be extended—most often at the **Solutions Layer**, where business capabilities and terminology vary most.

Extensions allow organizations to introduce new **types, categories, or names** that are not part of the standard taxonomy. These additions are **meant to complement—not replace—standard elements**, preserving alignment with the broader TBM model.

Common reasons to extend the taxonomy include:

- Capturing sector-specific capabilities such as *Clinical Systems* in healthcare, *Plant Operations* in manufacturing, or *Loan Servicing* in financial services
- Reflecting business models or regulatory requirements unique to the public sector or international operations
- Enabling deeper alignment to customer journeys, value streams, or market-facing product lines not covered by the standard Solution Types

Extensions may also include additional detail in the naming or organization of business services or digital products, particularly when solution portfolios are structured around product management frameworks, Technology service catalogs, or customer experience platforms.

To maintain compatibility, extensions must:

- Be additive, not substitutive
- Respect the established four-layer structure
- Avoid redefining existing taxonomy elements

The TBM Council publishes and maintains a growing set of formal **industry and vertical extensions** developed in partnership with member organizations. These include additions for sectors such as healthcare, financial services, government, higher education, and more.

Organizations interested in these extensions—or in contributing to their development—can visit the TBM Council taxonomy extension page for more information.

TBM COUNCIL

About the Technology Business Management Council

Founded in 2012, the Technology Business Management (TBM) Council is a nonprofit business entity dedicated to advancing the discipline of TBM through education, standards, and collaboration. Governed by an independent board of both global and regional business technology leaders, this diverse group represents some of the world's most innovative companies, including Mastercard, Wells Fargo, State Farm Insurance, Nike, Stanley Black & Decker, Equifax, ANZ Group, Commonwealth Bank of Australia, Adidas, Mercedes Benz, and more. The TBM Council provides best practices for leaders to leverage so they can react quickly to changing market dynamics and optimize cloud and agile strategies to deliver on business objectives.

About the TBM Council Standards Committee

The TBM Council Standards Committee, in partnership with TBM Council staff, is responsible for the development, review, and maintenance of TBM standards (including the TBM taxonomy, KPIs, and related metrics). The Committee reports to the TBM Council Board of Directors and is accountable for keeping the Board informed on the evolution of these standards.

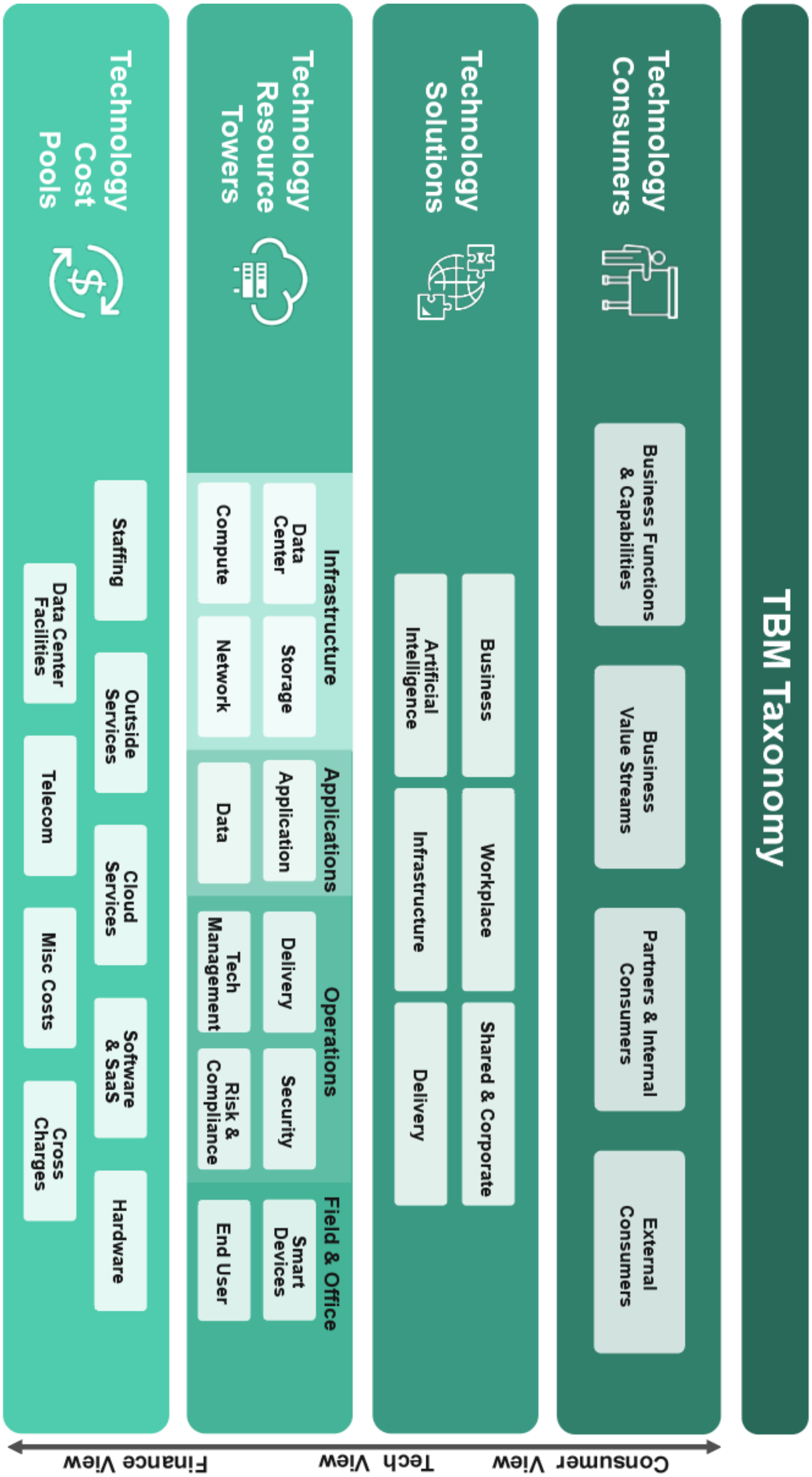
As stewards of the TBM framework, the Committee ensures all standards are clearly documented, publicly available to Council members, and open to community feedback.

Learn more at www.tbmcouncil.org/about/standards-committee.

Learn more and become a member at tbmcouncil.org

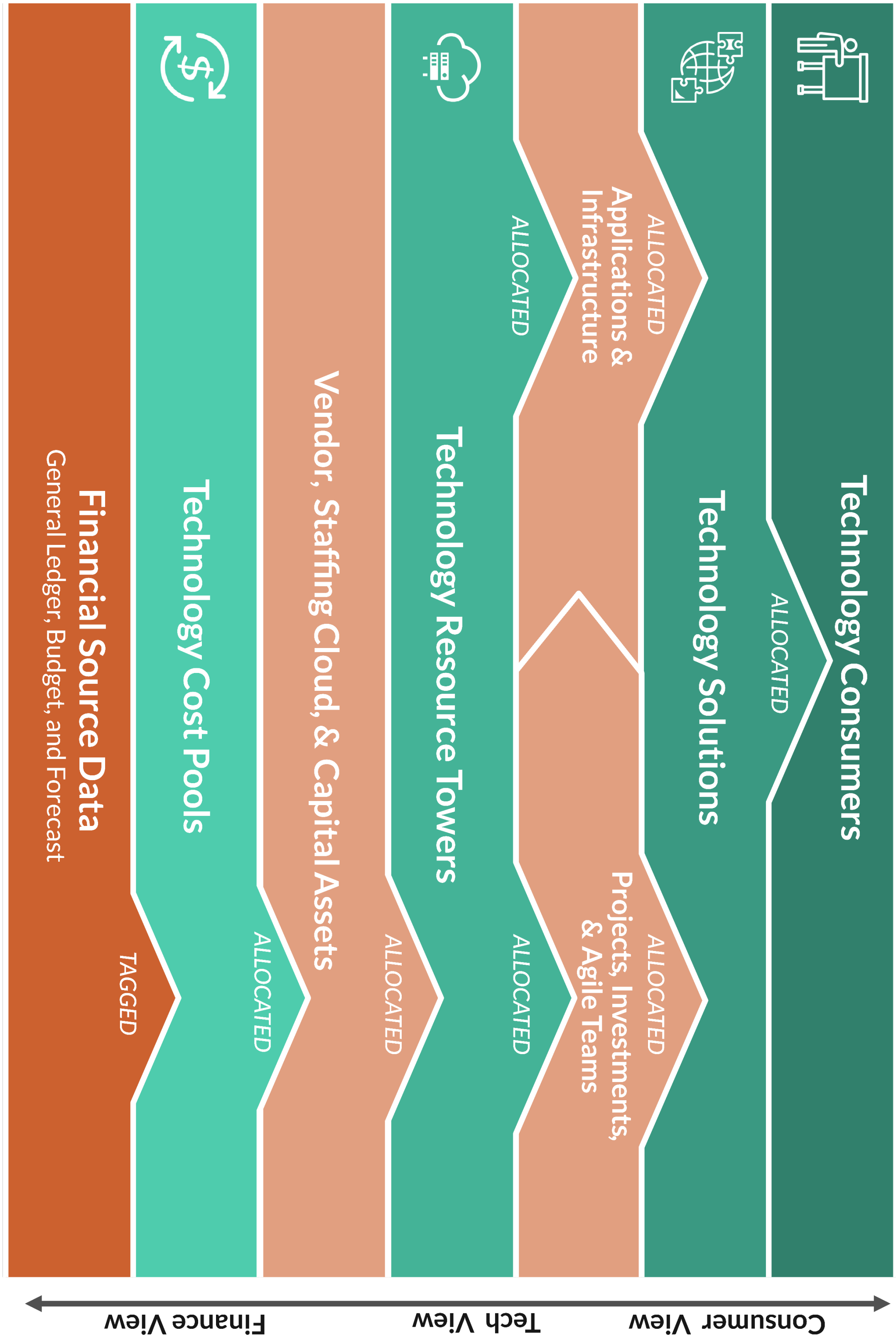
Appendix 1

Figure 1: TBM Taxonomy 5.0 Summary View



Appendix 2

Figure 2: Conceptual TBM Model



Appendix 3

Figure 3: TBM Taxonomy Cost Pools and Sub-Pools

Total Technology Expenses

	Staffing	Outside Services	Cloud Services	Hardware	Software & SaaS	Data Center Facilities	Telecom	Misc Costs	Cross Charges
OPERATING EXPENSES (OPEX)	Internal Labor	Consulting	Cloud Service Provider	Lease	Licensing	Lease	Lease	Managed Services	by Internal Department
	Staff Augmentation	Managed Services	Other Operating	Maintenance & Support	Maintenance & Support	Maintenance & Support	Maintenance & Support	Other Operating	
	Other Operating	Other Operating		Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation & Amortization	Depreciation & Amortization		
				Managed Services	SaaS	Managed Services	Managed Services		
				Other Operating	Other Operating	Other Operating	Other Operating		
CAPITAL EXPENSES (CAPEX)	Internal Labor Capital	Capital	Capital	Capital	Capital	Capital	Capital	Capital	
	Staff Augmentation Capital								

Appendix 4

Figure 4: TBM Taxonomy Tower and Sub-Towers

TBM Taxonomy 5.0 Technology Resource Towers

INFRASTRUCTURE				APPLICATION		OPERATIONS				FIELD & OFFICE	
Data Center	**Storage**	**Compute**	**Network**	**Application**	**Data**	**Delivery**	**Tech Management**	**Security**	**Risk & Compliance**	**Smart Devices**	**End User**
Enterprise Data Center	Online Storage	Servers	LAN	Development	Data Operations	Service Management	Tech Management & Strategy	Digital Security	Regulatory & Audit	Intelligent Devices	Workspace
Other Facilities	Offline Storage	Converged Infrastructure	WAN	Support & Operations	Data Management	Client Management	Tech Finance	Identity & Access Governance	Risk Management	Industrial & Control Systems	Mobile Devices
	Mainframe Online Storage	High Performance Compute	Voice & Collaboration	Licensing	Mainframe Database	Operations Center	Enterprise Architecture		Disaster Recovery		Network Printers
	Mainframe Offline Storage	Mainframe	AI Network	Middleware	Database	Tech Portfolio & Project Management	Tech Vendor Management				Conferencing & AV
	AI Storage	AI Compute	Network Management	Mainframe Middleware		Central Print	Tech Human Capital Management				Help Desk
		Quantum		Container Orchestration							Deskside Support
		Serverless		Blockchain & Tokenization							
		Auto-Scalers		AI Models							

Appendix 5

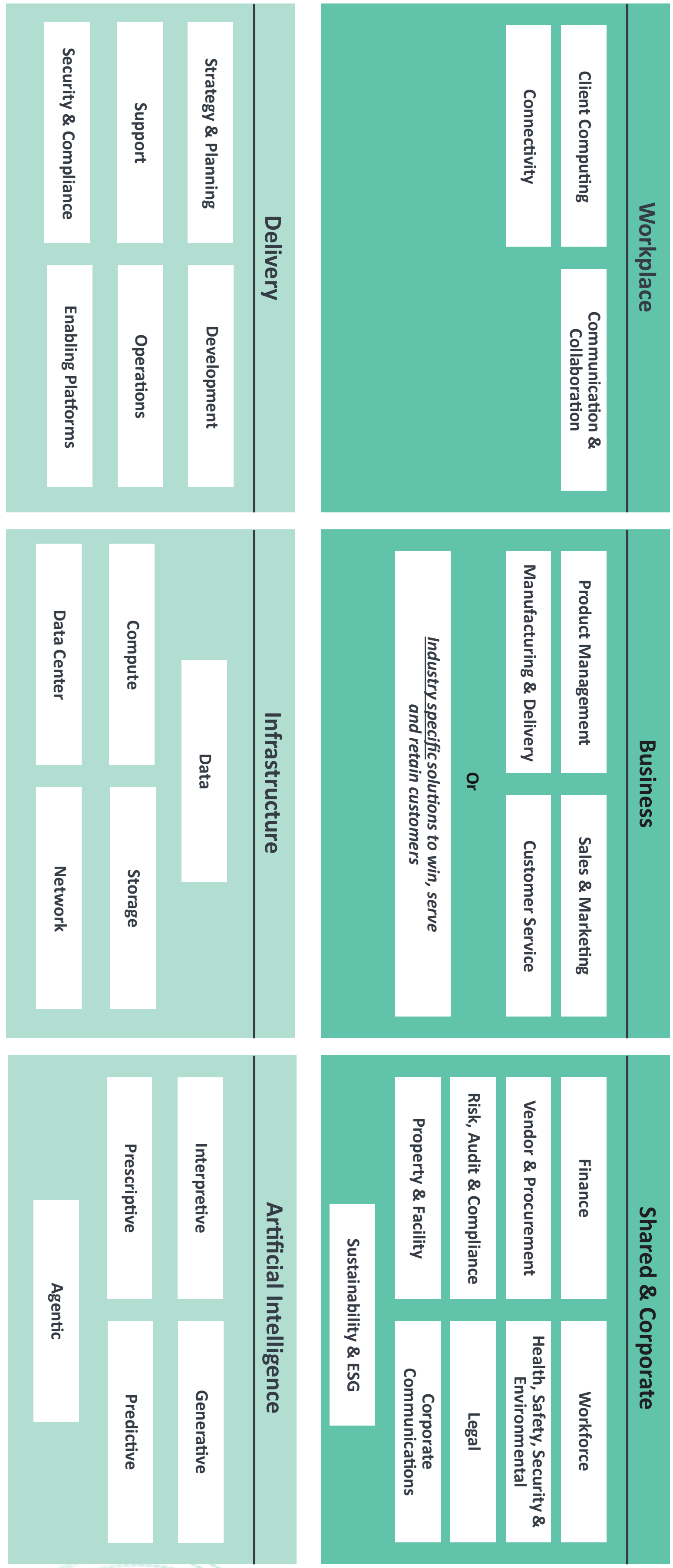
Figure 5: TBM Taxonomy Towers Hierarchy

Towers Hierarchy

Hierarchy		Example
1. Domain	Optional for higher-level categorization	» Infrastructure
2. Tower	Standard TBM Taxonomy	» Compute
3. Sub-Tower		» Servers
4. Sub-Tower Element	Optional for more granular aggregation and allocation	» Windows » Linux
5. Tags	Optional metadata for filtering and analysis	» AI Enabled = Yes » Project ID = PRJ1234

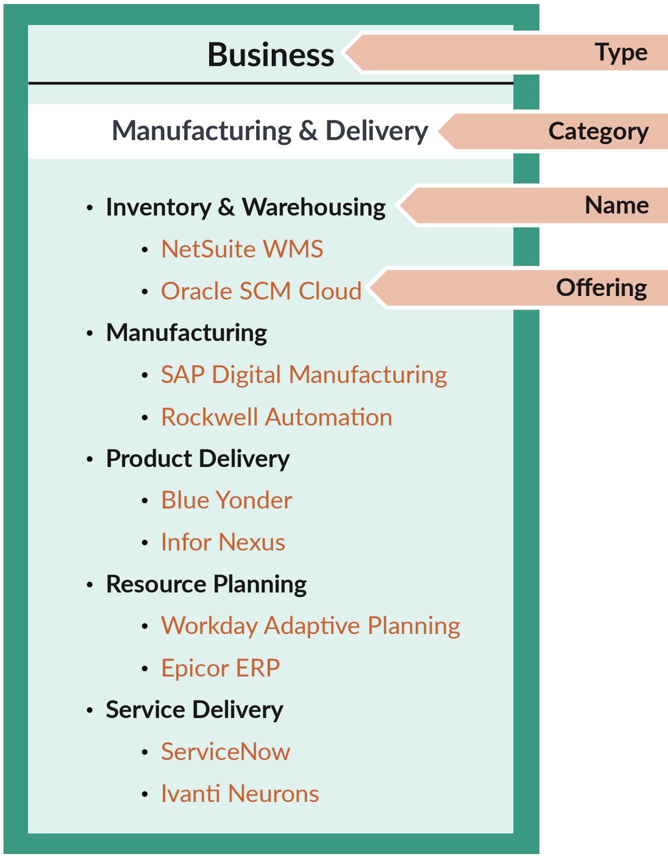
Appendix 6

Figure 6: TBM Taxonomy Solutions, Type & Category View



Appendix 7

Figure 7: TBM Taxonomy Solutions Hierarchy



Appendix 8

Figure 8: TBM Taxonomy Solution Consumers